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FREQUENTLY ASKED QUESTIONS

Pharmacy Prior Authorization Criteria

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Tremfya (guselkumab)

Indications for Prior Authorization

Tremfya SC (guselkumab)

- **For diagnosis of Plaque Psoriasis (PsO)**
Indicated for the treatment of adult patients with moderate-to-severe plaque psoriasis who are candidates for systemic therapy or phototherapy.
- **For diagnosis of Psoriatic Arthritis (PsA)**
Indicated for the treatment of adult patients with active psoriatic arthritis.
- **For diagnosis of Ulcerative Colitis (UC)**
Indicated for the treatment of adult patients with moderately to severely active ulcerative colitis.

Tremfya IV (guselkumab)

- **For diagnosis of Ulcerative Colitis (UC)**
Indicated for the treatment of adult patients with moderately to severely active ulcerative colitis.

Criteria

Tremfya SC 100 mg

If patient meets criteria above, please approve at GPI-14

Prior Authorization (Initial Authorization)

Length of Approval: 6 Month(s)

For diagnosis of Plaque Psoriasis (PsO)

- *Diagnosis of moderate-to-severe plaque psoriasis*
AND
- *One of the following [2]:*
 - Greater than or equal to 3% body surface area involvement
 - Severe scalp psoriasis
 - Palmoplantar (i.e., palms, soles), facial, or genital involvement**AND**
- *Minimum duration of a 4-week trial and failure, contraindication, or intolerance to one of the following topical therapies [3]:*
 - corticosteroids (e.g., betamethasone, clobetasol)
 - vitamin D analogs (e.g., calcitriol, calcipotriene)
 - tazarotene
 - calcineurin inhibitors (e.g., tacrolimus, pimecrolimus)**AND**
- *Prescribed by or in consultation with a dermatologist*

Tremfya SC 100 mg

If patient meets criteria above, please approve at GPI-14

Prior Authorization (Reauthorization)

Length of Approval: 12 Month(s)

For diagnosis of Plaque Psoriasis (PsO)

- *Patient demonstrates positive clinical response to therapy as evidenced by ONE of the following [1-3]:*
 - Reduction in the body surface area (BSA) involvement from baseline
 - Improvement in symptoms (e.g., pruritus, inflammation) from baseline

Tremfya SC 100 mg

If patient meets criteria above, please approve at GPI-14

Prior Authorization (Initial Authorization)

Length of Approval: 6 Month(s)

For diagnosis of Psoriatic Arthritis (PsA)

- *Diagnosis of active psoriatic arthritis (PsA)*
AND
- *One of the following [4]:*
 - Actively inflamed joints
 - Dactylitis
 - Enthesitis
 - Axial disease
 - Active skin and/or nail involvement**AND**
- *Prescribed by or in consultation with one of the following:*
 - Dermatologist
 - Rheumatologist

Tremfya SC 100 mg

If patient meets criteria above, please approve at GPI-14

Prior Authorization (Reauthorization)

Length of Approval: 12 Month(s)

For diagnosis of Psoriatic Arthritis (PsA)

- *Patient demonstrates positive clinical response to therapy as evidenced by at least one of the following [1, 4]:*
 - Reduction in the total active (swollen and tender) joint count from baseline
 - Improvement in symptoms (e.g., pain, stiffness, pruritus, inflammation) from baseline
 - Reduction in the body surface area (BSA) involvement from baseline

Tremfya IV

Prior Authorization

Length of Approval: 3 Month(s)

For diagnosis of Ulcerative Colitis (UC)

- *Diagnosis of moderately to severely active ulcerative colitis*
AND
- *One of the following [5, 6]:*
 - Greater than 6 stools per day
 - Frequent blood in the stools
 - Frequent urgency
 - Presence of ulcers
 - Abnormal lab values (e.g., hemoglobin, erythrocyte sedimentation rate, C-reactive protein)
 - Dependent on, or refractory to, corticosteroids**AND**
- *Trial and failure, contraindication, or intolerance to one of the following conventional therapies [5, 6]:*

- 6-mercaptopurine
- Azathioprine
- Corticosteroid (e.g., prednisone)
- Aminosalicylate (e.g., mesalamine, olsalazine, sulfasalazine)

AND

- Will be administered as an intravenous induction dose

AND

- Prescribed by or in consultation with a gastroenterologist

Tremfya SC

Prior Authorization (Initial Authorization)

Length of Approval: 6 Month(s)

For diagnosis of Ulcerative Colitis (UC)

- Diagnosis of moderately to severely active ulcerative colitis

AND

- Will be used as a maintenance dose following the intravenous induction doses

AND

- Prescribed by or in consultation with a gastroenterologist

Tremfya SC

Prior Authorization (Reauthorization)

Length of Approval: 12 Month(s)

For diagnosis of Ulcerative Colitis (UC)

- Patient demonstrates positive clinical response to therapy as evidenced by at least one of the following [1, 5, 6]:
 - Improvement in intestinal inflammation (e.g., mucosal healing, improvement of lab values [platelet counts, erythrocyte sedimentation rate, C-reactive protein level]) from baseline
 - Reversal of high fecal output state

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- Guideline ID
GL-156965

-
- Formulary
Premium

-
- Effective date
Nov 1, 2024

-
- P&T approval date
Sep 27, 2017

P & T Revisions

2024-10-10, 2024-09-15, 2024-03-04, 2023-12-20, 2023-10-16, 2023-02-26, 2022-10-24, 2022-03-02, 2021-09-27, 2021-05-26, 2021-05-25, 2021-03-02, 2020-09-02, 2020-03-03

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2. Menter A, Strober BE, Kaplan DH, et al. Joint AAD-NPF guidelines of care for the management and treatment of psoriasis with biologics. J Am Acad Dermatol 2019;80:1029-72.
3. Elmets CA, Korman NJ, Farley Prater E, et al. Joint AAD-NPF guidelines of care for the management and treatment of psoriasis with topical therapy and alternative medicine modalities for psoriasis severity measures. J Am Acad Dermatol 2021;84:432-70.
4. Singh JA, Guyatt G, Ogdie A, et al. 2018 American College of Rheumatology/National Psoriasis Foundation guideline for the treatment of psoriatic arthritis. Arthritis Rheumatol. 2019;71(1):5-32.

5. Rubin DT, Ananthakrishnan AN, Siegel CA, et al. ACG clinical guideline: ulcerative colitis in adults. Am J Gastroenterol. 2019;114:384-413.
 6. Feuerstein JD, Isaacs KL, Schneider Y, et al. AGA clinical practice guidelines on the management of moderate to severe ulcerative colitis. Gastroenterol. 2020;158:1450-1461.
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Revision History

- **2024-10-10:** Addition of criteria for ulcerative colitis
 - **2024-09-15:** Removed anthralin and coal tar as topical step options for PsO
 - **2024-03-04:** Annual review - no criteria changes; background updates
 - **2023-12-20:** Program update to standard reauthorization language. No changes to clinical intent.
 - **2023-10-16:** Program update to standard reauthorization language. No changes to clinical intent.
 - **2023-02-26:** Annual review - no criteria changes; background updates
 - **2022-10-24:** Further clinical detail and criteria added
 - **2022-03-02:** Annual review - no criteria changes
 - **2021-09-27:** Addition of EHB formulary to guideline, no changes to criteria
 - **2021-05-26:** Addition of EHB formulary to guideline, no changes to criteria
 - **2021-05-25:** Addition of EHB formulary to guideline, no changes to criteria
 - **2021-03-02:** Annual review - no clinical changes; background updates
 - **2020-09-02:** Addition of criteria for new psoriatic arthritis indication.
 - **2020-03-03:** Annual review - added objective measures to the reauth criteria; reference updates
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Provider Tools

Electronic Solutions Policies and Guidelines Pharmacy Management Health Promotion / Disease Management Quality & Safety Member & Provider Rights Language Assistance Program Provider Communications Forms & Downloads

Quick Links

Prior Auth Request Form

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WHA members have access to a wealth of resources including a wellness assessment, gym discounts, wellness classes and support groups, health education materials, and much more.

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